Turkey, Egypt, and Syria

A Travelogue

COMPILED BY

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ENTITLED

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سفرنامۂ روم و شام

مرتبہ

مولانا شبلی نعمانی

المخاطب بہ

شمس العلماء

پروفیسر عربی مدرسۃ العلوم علیگڈھ ۔ وفیلو آف یونیورسٹی الہ آباد

در مطبع مفید عام آگرہ طبع شد

طبع اوّل (۱۰۰۰ جلد)

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A Travelogue

In which, in addition to the small, interesting incidents that have arisen in the course of the narrative, the following circumstances related to Constantinople, Beirut, Jerusalem, Cairo, and so on, have been written in detail—that is, general circumstances of the city, sights worth visiting, famous buildings, the administration of the Department of Education, academies and madrasas, boarding houses and students, women's education, writers and their writings, libraries, newspapers and journals, encounters with famous pāshās and people of achievement, and the morals and habits of the Turks and Arabs. In the end, there is a very brief lexicon of the newly fashioned terms that have come into use in Egypt and Syria today, without knowledge of which, people cannot take advantage of Arabic newspapers.

Compiled by Shiblī Nuʿmānī

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List of Subjects

SUBJECT	PAGE	SUBJECT	PAGE
The Intention to Travel and Beginning of the Journey	*16*	Types of Lodging in Constantinople	*34*
From Bombay	*17–18*	The Companionship of Shaikh ʻAbd al-Fattāḥ and His Circumstances	*35*
Strange and Wondrous Animals	*21*	Meeting Shaikh ʻAli Zabyān by Means of a Writing	*35*
Port Said	*23*	Arrangements for Food	*36*
A Superficial Visit to Beirut	*25*	Qaṣīdah-e Safariyah	*36*
Change in the Condition of the Journey from Port Said	*25*	A Summary History of Constantinople and Brief Circumstances Thereof	*41*
The Indifference of Arabs by Reason of an Iranian Cap	*26*	The Present Condition of Constantinople	*42*
Cyprus	*27*	Fineness of Location and Scenery	*42*
Izmīr, meaning Smyrna	*29*		

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List of Subjects

SUBJECT	PAGE	SUBJECT	PAGE
Dress and Fashion	*46*	Classical Education and Classical Madrasas	*69*
Courts	*47*	The Intellectual-Scientific Condition of the Turks	*71*
The State of Education	*48*	Newspapers and Journals	*75*
Modern Education and Its Different Levels	*49*	More Caution Than Moderation [Calls For] in the Printing of Books	*76*
The Progress of Education in the Age of the Present Sulṭān and the Annual Expense of Education	*50*	Print Shops	*78*
The Invitation of Students by the Sulṭān	*50*	Libraries	*79*
Arrangements for the Education of the Arab People Especially	*51*	*Zawāyā*, Meaning Charitable Traveler Lodges for Every Country and Every Nation	*86*
Major Colleges and Schools	*52*	Congregational Mosques	*87*
The System of Boarding	*54*	Places Worth Seeing	*89*
The Dress of Students	*56*	*Tars-khānah*, Meaning Where Official Ships Are Built	*89*
Lack in the Progress in Education	*58*	Museum	*92*
The Military College	*59*	Places to Visit	*93*
The College of the Sulṭān	*65*	Muḥarram	*94*
The Mulkiyah College	*68*	*Salāmlaq*, Meaning the Great SulṭāN's Coming for Friday NamāZ and the Armies' Passing by for Inspection	*95*

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List of Subjects

SUBJECT	PAGE	SUBJECT	PAGE
Eid Procession	*100*	Societies and Newspapers	*133*
Maśnavī-i ʻĪdiyah	*100*	Meeting Scholars and People of Achievement	*135*
Turkish Morals, Habits, and Style of Social Life	*104*	Departure from Beirut	*138*
The Education, Training, Fashion, and Dress of Women	*110*	Bait al-Muqaddas [Jerusalem]	*140*
Hindustanis of Constantinople	*112*	Masjid-i Aqṣā [The Aqsa Mosque]	*141*
Dear Friends in Constantinople	*113*	Qammāmah [The Church of the Holy Sepulchre]	*143*
Meeting Ghazi ʻUśmān Pāshā	*115*	Meeting Scholars and Learned Men and Some Other Details	*144*
The Author's Receiving the Tamghah-I MajīDiyah [MajīDiyah Medal] and a Copy of the Tamghah and the SulṭāN's Decree	*117*	Departure from Bait al-Muqaddas	*146*
Departure from Constantinople	*120*	Cairo	*148*
An Unpleasant Event on the Ship	*121*	The Educational State of Miṣr [Egypt]	*149*
Beirut	*123*	The Number of Schools and College and Their Expenses	*150*
The Intellectual-Scientific Progress of Beirut	*124*	Dār al- ʻUlūm	*153*
The University of Beirut	*128*		

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List of Subjects

SUBJECT	PAGE	SUBJECT	PAGE
Law College	*157*	Burial Sites	*176*
Madrasa of Translation	*158*	Printing Houses and Newspapers	*177*
Medical College	*159*	Theaters	*179*
Engineering College and Madrasa of Industry and General Madrasas	*160*	Clubs and Societies	*180*
People Receiving Education in Europe	*162*	The Birthday of the Prophet (*ṣlaʿm*)	*181*
Jāmiʿ-e Azhar [The Azhar (Congregational) Mosque]	*164*	People of Achievement and Writers	*183*
Official Library	*168*	The End of the Journey and the Beneficent Morals of the Arabs	*187*
Ancient Monuments	*172*	The Arabic Language of the Present	*191*

Note: On line 3 on page 230 [in the Urdu original], the word *ḥawāyaj* should be read instead as *awāʿī*, and this word should be counted among the words in the alif [*a*] section.

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Preface

In the Name of God, the Compassionate, the Merciful

With Praise and Prayers[1]

Although we did not reach the land of roses in the season of roses
We did not let the spectacle of autumn fall from our hand.[2]

The journey that I made to Constantinople, and so on, in auspicious Ramżān, 1309 Hijrī / [March/April] 1892 was purely a student's journey, and because it was neither an extraordinary affair, nor was there much rareness in the happenings of the journey, I had absolutely no intention of writing a travelogue. However, after I returned from there, the elders and friends whom I had occasion to meet all demanded a travelogue. I thought that since the custom of travel and journey stopped in our community some time ago, and for this reason absolutely no acquaintance with the true circumstances of the Islamic regions is acquired, this demand by the people was not out of place. I was reminded of my own situation when, before the journey, any time I met a traveler from Constantinople, and so on, I would spend hours asking about the circumstances of that place. [3]

These were the reasons that persuaded me to give order to these scattered pages. Otherwise, to record the circumstances of such a hasty and ordinary journey, and to give it the name *safarnāmah* or *kitāb al-riḥlat*,[3] would not have been devoid of small wit. The kind of information that is necessary and required in a safarnāmah, that is, the general circumstances of the region, the method of administration, the principles of the court, the particularities of business and commerce, and sketches of buildings; not even one of these is found in this safarnāmah. Of course, there are

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a substantial number of incidents related to social life and intellectual-scientific circumstances, although they too are not as detailed as they should be. In sum, whoever desires to see the *Safarnāmah* as a safarnāmah will not be able to derive full pleasure from this book. Still, this potluck of whatever was at hand can be presented at the table setting of people who take pleasure in even the ordinary events of Islamic regions, for *mā lā yudrak kulluh lā yutrak kulluh*.[4]

Although I have not discussed the civilizational and regional circumstances of the Turks in this book, nor was a discussion of this kind appropriate with respect to my position and status, the degree of cultural refinement and propriety of the Turks that will be established in the hearts of readers will be different from that which is expressed by the general literature of Europe.

The thoughts against Muslims that Europe formed in some age in the past were, for a time, expressed openly in such a way that the hue of religious prejudice was clear to see, and at that time this was an excellent means of general acceptance. But when the [4] power of religion declined in Europe, and religious anthems became entirely ineffectual, that policy took a turn. Now it was not thought to be so beneficial to write such clearly prejudiced words about Muslims. Instead, the learned, scholarly practice was adopted that the flaws of Islamic governments, Islamic nations, and Islamic society be laid bare in historical ornament, and these have become so absorbed in the literature by means of common writings, stories, novels, and proverbs that they cannot be separated even by a chemical solution.

Although this practice is employed with all Islamic nations, at this time our discussion lies with the Turks in particular. Not having contemptuous thoughts about Turks after reading European literature is precisely like not feeling drowsy after taking a soporific drug.

The circle of scholars in Europe is quite extensive, and for this reason there are people of every degree and class among them: prejudiced and good hearted, superficial and discerning. But in discussion of the Turks, this difference of degrees collapses entirely, and the same sound issues from every instrument.

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For example, the straightforward and honest account of the truest of true European writers of today is that, in mentioning the Turkish government, he writes entirely straightforwardly of the heaviness of debt, the insufficiency of industry and technology, the absence of the expanse of education in the provincial districts, the dependency on Europe for weapons and armaments—all of this. But he so avoids mentioning the reforms that have taken place of late that it is as if reform does not exist at all. The administration of the treasury, the establishment of agricultural banks in all the provincial districts, [5] the progression of the number of *rushdiyah* schools from 96 to 405, the establishment of many large and great colleges, the extensiveness of the railway, the arrangements for discharging debt, the development of military power—he does not write about these events,* not even by mistake.[5]

An extremely easy method of proving a nation or a person praiseworthy or contemptable is to paint a one-sided picture of its circumstances and happenings, and the just truth of the matter is that Europe has used this deceptive method more than all other nations in the world.

No doubt, there are also beneficent people in Europe who have nothing to do with prejudice, but even their lack of prejudice is ineffective when confronted with the kind of thoughts among which they have been raised since childhood, the sources of information all around them, and the voices that enter their ears from all directions. One gentleman, who is an extremely unprejudiced and learned person and whom I have the honor of serving, returned from a journey to Constantinople and Egypt, and I asked in the course of conversation, "Did you also visit the Azhar Congregational Mosque in Cairo?"[6] He said, "I was very keen to visit it, but my guide said that Christians were not permitted to go there;" although this fact is purely erroneous. [6] I myself resided in the Azhar Congregational

* A separate book has been written and published in Constantinople detailing the intellectual-scientific and practical developments that have taken place in the time of the present sulṭān, and the tract by Rāsim Bey Āfandī discussing naval progress in particular has been published, the name of which is *Daur-i taraqqī* [The Age of Progress].

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Mosque for more than one month, and my Christian friends used to come to meet me right in the masjid without any trouble. But because in Europe the prejudice and narrow-mindedness of Muslims is very nearly axiomatic knowledge, how could that ṣāḥib have had any hesitation in believing the words of his guide?

To crown all, if anyone says or writes something that deviates from the common thoroughfare, his voice is thought to be the voice of a parrot in the drum chamber of Europe. An English princess, having lived in Constantinople for fifteen or sixteen years, wrote a book by the name of *The Twelve-Year Governance of ʿAbd al-Ḥamīd the Second*.[7] Although to be taken as credible—the intellectual capability of the authoress, the experience of fifteen or sixteen years, the authentic means of discovering information—all the attendant requisites were present; still, because it was not of one voice with Europe in speaking of the faults of the Turks, it was not able to obtain the status of reliability and trustworthiness. We have heard educated people say of it, "It would be no wonder if the Turks themselves wrote the book under the name of an assumed author, or if favors from the sulṭān compelled the British princess to write such a book!!" But if the same book had been about the faults of the Turks, then (according to these people) every letter of it would have been absolute and certain. Even the essays that Professor Vámbéry has written drawing from his scholarly investigations into the cultural refinement and propriety of the Turks remained ineffectual for the very reason that the aforementioned professor had acknowledged the present intellectual-scientific progress of the Turks.[8]

Although this is the state of the common literature of Europe concerning the Turks, with respect to the occasion, we should [7] mention in particular the travelogues of Turkey, for it is from these very travelogues that the resources of European historical writings have also largely been taken. Although the travelogue is an interesting part of the historical tradition, it is as replete with erroneous suppositions as it is interesting.

A major error that commonly befalls the writers of travelogues is establishing generalizations from particulars. Human beings establish a general view of an entire nation from the character, habits, and ideas of the people whom they encounter on a journey, even though it is possible

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that these matters are exclusive to those few people alone. Similarly, they desire to derive a general conclusion from every occurrence, and neither desire to spend time in search of the specific causes of each occurrence nor have occasion to do so.

One major cause of error is that the person who travels to some country already has friendly or opposing ideas about it. After arriving there, whatever he sees and hears at first is purely superficial, and because such cursory familiarity is not sufficient for the derivation of conclusions, and he cannot wait long to form conclusions, he therefore interposes conjectures with every incident. While making such conjectures, the positive or negative notion that already existed in his heart continues to act in silence and the person is completely unaware. Although erroneous supposition of this kind is connected with all the nations of the world, the people of Europe enjoy special superiority in it, the reason for which is that no other nation is [8] as impatient to derive conclusions as the Europeans. It is the effect of this that when a common European traveler or politician happens to turn up in Hindustan, on the basis of the experience of just a week or two, he publishes major articles in European newspapers and magazines claiming that it is as if all the secrets of the society and civilization of Hindustan have been revealed to him.

Another major reason is that because the traveler is extremely eager to discover information, he desires to acquire some resource or means of information from every person he encounters. In this generalizing, he does not care to discern if the person is trustworthy or untrustworthy, enlightened or prejudiced, or someone with an eye for finer points or who only sees the apparent, and even if he does desire to do so, he cannot do so successfully. Europeans are even more incautious in this regard. Most European tourists who travel to Constantinople typically have occasion to stay in the hotels of Bayoghlī [Beyoğlu] and Ghalatah [Galata].[9] Wherever they want to go, a *gāyaḍ* (guide) is with them who not only takes them on a tour of the buildings and places, but also answers all the questions that they ask from time to time as needed.[10] These guides are generally Christian, and their rate is a rupee or two per day. Everyone can estimate for oneself what kind of information these guides can have.

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Fāṭimah Khānam* has written in the preface of her book, "When the esteemed European women [9] whom I had occasion to meet would recount something relating to Turkish women as fact, I used to suspect that they were discussing some other nation or they were stories in the style of a novel." Fatimah Khānam has also given the opinion that, "It is not the fault of these poor people. They are compelled to believe whatever guides say to tourists." A guide also deceived our friend, who was deprived of a visit to the Azhar Congregational Mosque.

In sum, it was inevitable that my travelogue would be different from European writings and travelogues, although it would not have been befitting to go into such excessive detail in describing the reasons for this difference that it became its own separate subject or section.

It is not at all necessary to express here the impression that the journey to Turkey has left on my heart. This can be learned by reading this safarnāmah. Of course, it is necessary to say at the very least that if the status of the sultanate is set aside, then the condition of Muslims there, too, is not worthy of much joy or satisfaction. Rather, one should say that in a great many matters, it is very close to that of Hindustani Muslims. They have nothing to do with industry. They have very little share in commercial trade. Even the ordinary shopkeepers are Jewish or Christian. The old education is extremely defective [10] and continues to become more and more so. The complaint concerning new education that is made here is also made there. There is still enmity between the old culture and the new culture, and no composite temperament has been produced by mixing the two. Those of the old way of thinking are still unaware of the

* This is an extremely esteemed and educated lady who, in addition to Arabic, Persian, and Turkish (which is her mother tongue), knows French extremely well. In order to reform the kind of erroneous information about Turkish women that Europe possesses (see page 9) [8–9] she has written a book in the form of novel whose name is *Nisā' al-Muslimīn* [*The Muslim Women*]. This book has been translated into Arabic, and, having been presented at the American exhibition, has been translated into English under the care of that place. [The 1901–2 edition adds, "It has also been translated into Urdu, and has been published at the Muhammadan Press at Aligarh."] [Fāṭimah Khānam, *Nisā' al-muslimīn*, trans. Saʿīd Aḥmad (Aligarh: Muhammadan Press, n.d.)]

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pace of the times. Those of the new taste do not do as much as they say. Instead of courage, dignity, passion, resolve, and fortitude, something like despondency has spread over the entire nation (predominantly). People are content with whatever circumstance they find themselves in. The present situation is, *laʿallallāha yuḥdiṡu baʿda żālika amran*.[11]

IT ENDED WELL

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The Intention to Travel and Beginning of the Journey

The Reason for the Intention to Travel. At the time when the idea for the Heroes of Islam[1] occurred to me, the thought also occurred to me that the historical material that existed in our country could not in any way suffice for this purpose. It was this thought that initially produced the motivation for this journey in my heart because I was certain that such a series of compositions could surely be prepared from the balance of Islamic writings that remains in Egypt and Turkey.

Although this resolution had already become firm, for various reasons there continued to be a delay. So much so that for obvious reasons I became somewhat hopeless, and the resolution remained nothing more than a feeble idea. Last year, by a strange coincidence, this intention was set in motion, and, with that motion, was completed. I was often ill last year. So much so that, having grown weary of the treatments, I intended to have a change of climate. Accordingly, I wrote numerous letters to friends in Almora and Kashmir to arrange for a house, and so on. Meanwhile, I learned that Mr. Arnold, who is professor of philosophy at the academy and my ustād (I have learned French from him), was planning to go to Europe in the coming days.[2] At once the thought occurred to me that the journey to Egypt and Turkey, the change of climate, the company of Mr. Arnold—all these things had happened to come together; this moment should be considered an extremely great blessing. [2] Thus, right then I went to see the aforementioned gentleman to say, "I will go with you." He expressed extreme happiness and said, "As far as possible, I shall give you sufficient assistance in the necessary tasks of the journey."

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At that time, only three or four days remained before the departure of the ship. When friends and dear ones heard, they were utterly astonished, and most tried to make me understand, "Such a great journey with such haste and lack of means; what kind of wisdom is this?" I said:

har chih bādābād man kashtī dar āb andākhtam.[3]

Summer vacation at the college is typically three months long. As per my period of employment, I was entitled to privileged leave of three months. Thus, putting both together, I had six months' leave, and on April 26, 1892, I left Aligarh. Mr. Arnold had departed for Jhansi a day or two before to meet with a friend of his. We met at Jhansi station, and the entire trip was spent in great pleasure and enjoyment. Mr. Arnold had informed Hājī Raḥmatullāh bin Da'ūd, who is an esteemed and enlightened merchant in Bombay, of his arrival by a means of a letter, in which my company was also mentioned. Because, as it happened, our prior arrangements had changed to some extent, we arrived at Bombay two days after the scheduled date. Mr. Arnold took his and my things to the Western hotel.[4] I was strolling around the market when I encountered a boy. I asked him, "Do you know Ḥājī Raḥmatullāh?" He asked, "Aren't you Maulawī Shiblī?"[5] I was amazed by this intuitive perception of his, which was nothing short of revelation. He said, "We have been wondering about you for two days," and said, "Please, come with me. Ḥājī ṣāḥib is expecting you." [3] Ḥājī ṣāḥib called Mr. Arnold, too, from the hotel, and we both stayed in his garden.

Our ship was to depart on the day after we arrived at Bombay. Thus, we spent all our time making the necessary preparations for the journey and were not able to tour the Islamic madrasas and societies that are in Bombay. We bought our ticket through the Cook Company.[6] The rate of a second-class ticket from Bombay to Port Said on the ship on which we were going was 210 rupees. I made the terrible mistake of not buying a return ticket, the result of which was that I was compelled to pay twenty-one pounds, that is 335 rupees, upon my return from Port Said to Bombay. We boarded the ship at nine o'clock on the morning of the first of May. At approximately twelve o'clock, the ship raised anchor and, reciting *bismillāh majrīhā wa-mursāhā*,[7] we said goodbye to Hindustan. There were only five travelers in second class, and by a curious coincidence all of

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them were from a different nation and a different race.[8] That is, one Muslim, one English, one Parsi, one Spanish, and one Siamese.

The Ocean Air. The motion of the ship did not seem too disagreeable at first. But around evening, my constitution began to change for the worse. I ate dinner and went to sleep. When my eyes opened in the morning, I was in a strange state. The discomfort from dizziness and nausea was too severe to describe. For two days, I remained in a state like that of fainting. The ship attendant sometimes brought tea, biscuits, and tangerines, telling me to eat something. But upon seeing those things, I would begin to retch. Mr. Arnold always drank tea. Even though it did not stay down, [4] one felt some relief by vomiting. At his insistence, I, too, drank tea a few times and vomited, and felt some benefit. On the third day, we all recovered and sprang to life. I had always heard that sea air was extremely beneficial for one's health and fitness. Truly, travel by ship stands out as one treatment among a hundred treatments. I was weak and feeble up to the time that I boarded. But with each passing day I became haler and heartier. My constitution was always cheerful and I had quite an appetite. We were given food five times a day, that is, tea, milk, and biscuits at eight o'clock in the morning; ordinary food at eleven o'clock in which there were dishes of numerous kinds; tiffin at one o'clock; dinner at five o'clock, in which, in addition to ordinary meat, there were chicken, duck, pigeon, puddings of every kind, and wet and dry fruits. Sometimes there was even *kulfi*.[9] Tea and butter at nine o'clock at night. We ate our fill at every meal and everything was digested.

A Christian's Prejudice against the Arabic Language. I kept busy all day, walking along, taking in the view of the sea. Mr. Arnold had begun learning Arabic. The Spanish Christian who was with us used to become heated about Mr. Arnold's reading Arabic. He would often come to him and pronounce the Arabic letters contemptuously in an extremely nasty voice, and would say, "This language is the language of camels." Although I was offended by these actions of his, such treatment of Arabs and the Arabic language by a nation that had lived with disgrace for a time under the hand of Arabs was not inappropriate.

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Winged Animals Were Slaughtered in Accordance with Żabḥ. Because it is generally reported that winged animals are not slaughtered according to *żabḥ* on ships,[10] and Maulawī Samīʿullāh Khān ṣāḥib[11] [5] has even confirmed this in his travelogue, I abstained from eating fowl meat for a few days. Mr. Arnold asked me the reason for this. I said, "In our religion, an animal killed by strangulation is haram." He told me, "On this ship, fowl are slaughtered with żabḥ. They are not killed by wringing their necks." Because, according to sharia, his testimony alone was not sufficient, I went and confirmed this myself. The person doing the żabḥ was a Christian. He did not recite anything at the time of żabḥ. He just slid the knife across the throat. Although an animal slaughtered by this method of żabḥ is not halal among the Ḥanafīs, for a few days I became a Shāfiʿī on this issue, according to whom every kind of *żabīḥah* is permissible.[12]

On the ship, Mr. Arnold was no longer the Arnold that he was in Aligarh. Neither was there that seriousness, nor that standoffishness. He would often laugh and joke, play with children, and skip and jump on the deck. I began to write an ode[13] about the circumstances of the trip, and in fact the atmosphere of the ocean was so appealing and pleasant that a man of suitable and balanced nature could not help but break into a hum on a journey by ship.

The Despicable Actions of the Somali Nation. On May 7, 1892, the ship arrived at Aden and dropped anchor at a distance from the shore. A very interesting thing in Aden is that a great many boys of the Somali nation aboard dinghies come close to the ship and make all kinds of strange, disgraceful movements for reward from the people on the ship. Some dance and sing. Some come together and say a few meaningless words as they play their armpits. The remarkable thing is that people toss whatever they wish to reward them, *do-annī*, *chau-annī*, paise, into the ocean, and the boys dive in and retrieve it. Most Europeans were engaged in the spectacle, and Arnold, too, enjoyed it. But [6] my state was something different, for I mistakenly thought that this place was generally populated by Arabs. For this reason, it was natural that I should look at them with eyes of respect and affection. But they made such unbefitting and disgraceful movements for reward that my nature could in no way endure it. It

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was like a cautionary lesson that the state of the Arabs was now such that they were not ashamed to act this way in front of others. These thoughts filled my heart with grief. So much so that tears flowed from my eyes and *qumm yā ʿUmar*[14] spontaneously issued from my tongue. Arnold was nearby. He noticed the change in my state. I described the condition of my heart and the reasons for it. Raising his eyes once, he looked at me and fell silent. When, having gone into the city to investigate, it was proved by all accounts that the Somali nation is not Arab, I was to some extent reassured. This very anger and offense was the reason that I have harshly ridiculed this wretched nation in my travel ode and, in truth, it deserves it.[15]

Because time was short, I could not see the interior parts of the city. I dispatched letters to Hindustan. On the heading of one letter I wrote these couplets, which were composed just then:

> When, intent on this journey, I girded my loins, with this intent of mine
> I cast both enemies and friends into writhing and twisting.
> All wondered: What is to be gained by it?
> For what have I cast myself into such affliction?
> Everyone gave me advice, and all said that I had,
> With these words, cast a mask from the cheeks of meaning.
> When they carried their insistence over the limit, I said, "Enough!
> Let come what may! I have cast my boat into the water."[16]

The Language of Aden. The language of Aden is generally Arabic, and the Parsis, Hindus, and Bengalis, [7] who live here on account of commerce or service, speak Arabic effortlessly. Because I had never heard the words of this sacred language from the tongue of a Hindu, I felt a strange pleasure seeing merchants and grocers[17] saying, "*Aina tarūḥ*? *Mā tabghī*?"[18]

The language here is Arabic, but it is extremely base and ineloquent. Although classical Arabic no longer exists in any of the regions where Arabic is spoken these days, the language of Aden is the most peculiar. Except for a few ordinary words, I could not understand anything. Most likely, the language of this place has reached this state after a period of continual degradation because of admixture with foreigners. ʿAllāmah [very learned] Muqaddasī,[19] who was a renowned traveler of Arabia and who traveled the world at the beginning of the fourth century, writes in

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his geography, "The nations that reside in Aden are mostly Persian." The aforementioned very learned scholar has also written, "They commonly say *kāf* [*k*] instead of *jīm* [*j*] here, and *rujlīnah* instead of *rujliyah*,[20] and so on." When such was the state of things in the age of the ʿallāmah, what complaint can be made about the language of this place after the mixture of Marhaṯṯas and Gujaratis?

Strange and Wondrous Monkeys. In Aden, a German boarded our ship who is an employee at a famous German museum and is returning to Europe after living in these environs for some time.[21] By virtue of travel and trade, he was able to speak effortlessly in numerous languages. When he conversed with the ship's officers in Italian, Arnold in English, and me in Arabic, I was seriously astonished and envious. When we all gathered at the dinner table, he was the one who acted as everyone's interpreter. [8] He has collected many strange and wondrous animals from the jungles of Arabia and Africa. In one large cage, there were African monkeys whose appearance was somewhat different from ordinary monkeys. The most wondrous thing about them was that when, seeing someone coming toward them, they would cry out, and several letters seemed to come from the sounds that they made. At first, I thought that they were made-up words of some kind, just as we interpret the sound of cats as *miyāʾon*, for example. But several times, when I listened closely, I clearly sensed the sound of *l* and *yāyā*. So much so that if some person had heard it from behind a curtain, he could never have thought that it was the voice of a monkey. When I mentioned this to Mr. Arnold, he, too, confirmed it. Probably because of examples of this kind, the idea has occurred to several people in Europe that monkeys, too, can speak. Thus, it is famously noted that after a period of experiment and research, one ṣāḥib has discovered several letters of this language.[22]

An Unpleasant Incident and Mr. Arnold's Steadiness. Because in Aden new things of interest had been found, we were traveling with great pleasure. But the very next day, a dangerous incident occurred which kept me seriously worried for a while. When I awoke on the morning of May 10, a fellow traveler said that the ship's engine had broken. When I looked,

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the captain and the ship's employees were indeed worriedly pacing about and were devising strategies to repair it. The engine had become completely useless, and the ship was moving along extremely slowly because of the wind. I became terribly worried, and some extremely disagreeable thoughts began to enter my mind. What else could I have done in this state of panic? I ran to Mr. Arnold. At that time, he was reading a book with extreme calm and composure. [9] I said, "Haven't you heard the news!?" He said, "Yes, the engine has broken." I said, "Aren't you panicked? What kind of time is this to read a book?" He said, "If the ship is to be lost, then this little bit of time is even more precious, and it is total stupidity to squander such precious time." Because of his steadiness and boldness, I also felt reassured and regained composure. Eight hours later, the engine was repaired and began to run as usual.

The ship arrived at Suez on May 13 and stayed for three or four hours. Egyptian Arabs brought paneer, dates, and bread to sell. One of them, understanding me to be Hindustani, began to speak with me in Urdu. I was surprised, and when I learned by inquiry that he had never seen the face of Hindustan, I was even more surprised at the worldwide reach of Urdu. On May 14, we arrived at Port Said, and with much regret I was forced to separate from Mr. Arnold. I had purchased a ticket to Brindisi from Bombay. Having arrived at Port Said, I thought, "I am with Arnold as far as Brindisi, but it is a week's journey from there to Constantinople. During that time, because I will have to deal with strangers and the foreign language and country, I will face difficulty in every task." On the basis of this thought, I changed the previous scheme entirely and decided that I would go to Constantinople by way of Syria.

When the ship anchored, a Cook Company employee came aboard to take care of his travelers. The ship stands at a bit of distance from the shore. Thus, a very small boat provided by the Cook Company is always ready to carry travelers ashore. [10] An inexperienced person faces serious difficulty when disembarking the ship at these ports. With the anchoring of the ship, coolies and sailors attack from every direction and seriously harass the travelers. Amid their throng, noise, shouting, and the snatching and seizing of luggage, travelers completely lose their senses. When, with a thousand difficulties, one finally reaches the shore, the debate and dispute

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over the rate lasts for hours. An excellent way to remain safe from these troubles is not to have any dealings with anyone except for the employees of the Cook Company.

When we arrived on shore, Shemūyal [Samuel], who was already standing waiting for us, stepped forward and shook hands with us. This man is of the Jewish nation and is appointed to look after travelers and to render them assistance of every kind. He knows numerous languages and speaks Arabic, English, and French extremely effortlessly. The best part is that he can speak in Urdu with extreme ease, the reason for which is that he has lived for some time in Hindustan. We went with him to his office. The office building is on the edge of the water and is nicely appointed with a table and chairs. On the desk are always found a great many newspapers, in which there is mostly news and advertisements related to ships. First, we spoke with him about having the ticket changed, meaning that if we disembarked here and bought a new ticket for Constantinople, could we receive the additional rate that we had already paid as far as Brindisi as a deduction or not? Because he could not answer the question himself, he went into the company's main office, and, upon returning, said, "You can go to Constantinople on the same ticket. You will only have to pay two pounds, meaning thirty-two rupees, more." I was very pleased and in reward for his good service gifted him eight rupees. [11] It was also a happy coincidence that the ship going to Constantinople was ready at that time. Otherwise, I would have had to remain at Port Said for fifteen days.

Port Said. Port Said is a small, beautiful port. The populated area has two parts. European merchants generally live in the part that adjoins the sea, and there are many large hotels, coffeehouses, theatres, and so on. One coffeehouse is right on the seashore and is quite spacious and atmospheric. Many small tables made of slabs of marble stone, and around them chairs, have been arranged with extreme attention to order and detail. Coffee, chai, toast, and butter are always available. The shops in this area are in abundance, and they are extremely grand and well appointed. The original residents of this place reside in the other part. But unfortunately, everything is in an extremely poor state. Instead of hotels, there are the dirty shops of cooks.

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Initially, when I left to tour the city, I viewed everything with eyes of great interest and wonder because this was the first occasion on which I saw a populated area of the sultanate of Islam. (I had already had the honor of pilgrimage to Mecca and Medina, but that was the country of God, and I am talking about a worldly sultanate and government).[23] Whenever I saw a tall and magnificent building, I would become happy at the thought that "Praise be to God! In these regions, Muslims are prosperous and wealthy!"[24] But upon inquiry, I would learn that the building belonged to a European merchant. Not one excellent store or tall building in the entire city belonged to a Muslim. Alas!

In every land we reached, the sky is found.[25]

[12] Of course, there is a royal masjid at the end of the European settlement, and it is quite lofty and magnificent.

After wandering around the marketplace for a little while, I boarded the ship to Constantinople. Shemūyal and Mr. Arnold were with me. Because it was the time for ḥajj to Jerusalem, first and second classes were both filled with Christian ḥājīs. Mr. Arnold said, "I fear lest you be troubled. These people are strict adherents to their religious tradition, and therefore they are certain to hold some prejudice. You are of another religion, another nation. How will these people tolerate your company?" But from experience, I learned that Mr. Arnold was mistaken. Those people were adherent to religion, but they were French and Italian. They were not English. Thus, they lacked entirely the qualities of aloofness and the distinction between conqueror and conquered that are the special characteristics of a conquering nation. Mr. Arnold departed after a little while. I said goodbye to him, and, along with that, had the worrisome thought, "Let's see how it goes now, all alone."

On May 15, the ship arrived at Jaffa. Most of our European fellow travelers disembarked here. Jerusalem is only a night's journey from here. Because time was short, I could not disembark here.

On May 16, we arrived at Beirut. The ship generally does not stop here for less than two watches [six hours]. Because this is a historical place, and it is an extremely ancient city, I was very keen to see it. Having arrived on

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shore, I was faced with the great difficulty that they did not let anyone disembark there without a *tażkirah*, meaning a passport.[26] I had left Hindustan in such a hurry that I did not have an opportunity to obtain a passport. First, I became very worried that I would miss out on the visit. But then an idea came to me, and I said to the people, [13] "I do not want to stay here. My intention was only to visit." One of them, God knows how, recognized that I was from Hindustan. Thinking me to be far from home, he treated me kindly and sent a person with me: "He will take you on a tour of the city."

A Visit to Beirut. Because it was already my intention to stay here for a day or two on my return from Constantinople, I only cursorily toured the marketplace, and so on, this time. I looked through bookstores. There was a coffeehouse on the main thoroughfare. I stopped there for a little while and watched the passersby. Whenever a person passed in front of me in a carriage or on horseback with great glory and grandeur, I would ask my guide who it was, and he would mostly respond, "Christian."

The thing I liked most here was that all the shop owners and professionals, even the coolies and laborers, were extremely well dressed and clean clothed. After strolling around for three or four hours, I returned. I gave the guide an eight-anna tip, and, having taken leave of him, boarded the ship.

From Port Said, a Change in the Condition of the Journey. The novelty that occurred in the circumstances of the journey from Port Said was that, from Bombay to Port Said, there was no Muslim on the ship. Having arrived here, I caught a glimpse of one or two Muslims, and, in Beirut, the entire ship filled up with Syrian Arabs. Unfortunately, this honor did not fall to the lot of first and second class, but in third class there were Muslims and only Muslims in every direction. I had longed to see the faces of Muslims since the outset of the journey. Upon seeing this crowd, my happiness knew no bounds. The deck of first class was an extremely clean and spacious place, and I often sat there and took in the ocean view. But when this company fell to my lot, I did not set foot there again, not even by mistake. [14]

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Initially, I met with severe difficulty in making friends with these people. These people were spread out all around the deck, and there were separate groups of two to four people each. I very eagerly approached them, but they paid absolutely no attention to me. Whomever I stood near raised his eyes toward me once and lowered his head. I was seriously stunned at this rudeness. I said in my heart, "And I had heard such praises of the hospitality of the Arabs! They have trouble making even casual conversation." Among them were several students from the Military College who had come to their homeland on break and now were going to Constantinople.[27] They sometimes read an Arabic dīwān, and so on, to amuse themselves. I thought that I should produce some acquaintance with them by means of our sharing a field of learning. Thus, I went to them and began to make a show of my *maulawiyat* and knowledge. Even then, they did not pay attention to me. I returned, feeling foolish and at a loss. But I was certain that there must be some reason for this. As it happened, one person asked me my religion. I said, "Islam." He said, "*Lā*! *Wa-Allāh*! *A hāżā ṭarbūsh al-Muslim*?"[28] meaning, "No! Would a Muslim ever wear such a cap?" Unfortunately, there was an Iranian cap on my head, and for this reason all the Arabs thought I was a Magian. When this mystery was solved, I removed the suspicion from their hearts and we became as inseparable as milk and sugar. So much so that they did not want to be apart from me for even a single breath. I mostly kept company with the students of the Madrasah-i Ḥarbiyah. From them, I learned some very important things about Constantinople, and, in truth, I benefitted greatly from the information.

The Effect of Islamic Government. The effect of our now being in the Islamic world was also noticeable on the ship. From Bombay to Suez, [15] the travelers in third class were treated like coolies. But in these regions, the situation changed entirely. Whatever the ship's officers and employees, who are generally European, thought of the travelers in their hearts, they could not mistreat them outwardly. There were numerous occasions on which I saw that it was the Muslims who were out of line, but the officers of the ship were forced to turn a blind eye.

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Cyprus. On May 17, the ship arrived at Cyprus.* This is a small island, which is located in the Sea of Turkey, and which they call Qubruṣ in Arabic. This island is a monument of the classical conquests of Islam. Amīr Muʿāwiyah attacked it in the time of Ḥażrat ʿUṡmān (ra) in 27 Hijrī [647–48].[29] The people of the city signed a treaty declaring that, "Just as we give tribute to the sultanate of Turkey, we shall give you, too, 7,200 dinars per year, and if ever there is war between you and the Romans, we will not have any involvement with anyone." Amīr Muʿāwiyah accepted this condition. But in 32 Hijrī [652–53], those people, against their promise, gave assistance to the Romans against the Muslims. The aforementioned amīr attacked again with a fleet of five hundred ships and conquered it with extreme ease. Still, he allowed the amount of tribute and the conditions of the truce to remain the same. On his order, twelve thousand Arabs went and settled there and built buildings and masjids. After some time, this island fell from the hand of the Muslims, and, having been conquered several times, was lost again. At last, the Turks took it back from the Christians in 1570, and it was in their control until recently. In the last war between Turkey and Russia, the English took it on the condition [16] that the sulṭān would continue to receive the yearly tribute that he used to receive.[30] Thus, now there is English rule and English administration there.

Larnaca [Larnakah] and Limassol [Limāmūn] are two large cities on this island, and the ship anchors at both places for a short while. I visited Limassol. Because there is English governance here, there was no passport inquiry and inspection. When I entered the city, I was wearing an Iranian cap on my head and a *shirwānī achkan* on my body.[31] The people there probably had never seen this fashion. Wherever I passed by, people would look at me in wonder, and wherever I stood, a crowd of spectators would form. I first went into the congregational masjid. There is a

* It is written in books of geography that in the classical age there were 9 districts, 12 cities, 805 villages, and 10 lākh residents on this island. The Turks seized it in 1570. Now there are seventy thousand inhabitants. Larnaca's wine is extremely famous, and its silk, too, is quite excellent.

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school adjacent to the masjid. There, a *maulawī* ṣāḥib, who was extremely dignified and well dressed, was giving lessons to the elementary ranks. I greeted him with *salām ʿalaik* [peace be upon you]. He stood up and, responding to my greeting with extreme kindness, indicated for me to sit. The boys were seated on tripod stools. I, too, sat down beside them. At the maulawī's indication, one boy read several verses of the Holy Quran. A wondrous effect came over my heart. I thought, "How could one even compare that desert of Hijaz with the distant islands in the Sea of Turkey?! What effect was there in this sacred word (the Quran) that, like electric force, it raced from the East to the West and still remains today?" That innocent boy also had a nice voice and read in accordance with the principles of recitation. As it happened, the verses were also effective. These things rendered me half-conscious, and for a while I was overcome by a strange, wondrous state.

Although the English have been ruling here for fifteen or sixteen years, they have maintained a great many old things in the style of administration with regard to policy. [17] The department of *qażā* is entirely separate, and the English government has no involvement with sharia cases.[32] I happened to pay my respects to the qāżī ṣāḥib. He is a very polite and dignified person. The method of education, too, is entirely in accordance with the Turkish system. In all the schools and madrasas, the books of the Turkish Department of Education are taught. In the school that I just mentioned, the Holy Quran, an introductory tract on fiqh [jurisprudence], history, and geography are included in the course, and instruction takes place in an extremely fine manner. I also visited this school when returning from Constantinople. It was in the morning, and the instructor ṣāḥib had not yet come at that time. Two or three boys were present. They treated me with extreme respect and good manners. One asked me, "Where is your homeland?" I said, "Hindustan." He said, "Hindustan is a vast region. Please tell me the name of the city, specifically." I mentioned Aligarh. He began to say, "I will see on the map where it is located." A map of Hindustan was hanging in front. He took a brief look at it and immediately set his finger on Aligarh and said, "Yes, this is it!" He was not more than nine or ten years old. Accordingly, I was surprised by his sharpness and memory. I asked, "Who is your king?" He said, "*Āfandim*."

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In Turkish, *āfandī* is synonymous with "lord and master." And when the first-person *m* is affixed, then the sulṭān is generally meant. I said, "But the English are ruling here." He said, "Yes, they have taken it on lease and they pay an annual tribute." The policy and practical philosophy [18] of the British is extremely wise, that when they seize control of a region, they do it so gradually and mildly that the people of the region are not even aware of the regime change.

The language of this place is Turkish, and this is also the language of every city and town from here to Constantinople. One can estimate the dominance of the rule of the Turks from the fact that they changed even the language of the conquered regions. Asia Minor is such a vast region, and an abundance of Christians reside in it whose language at some time was Greek or Latin, but now Turkish is spoken throughout the entire region. Although the maulawī ṣāḥib and qāżī ṣāḥib of Cyprus, whom I mentioned, knew Arabic well, they could not speak it. Of course, they could understand ordinary sentences, and I spoke with them relying on these.

What accurate estimate of the state of the Muslims of this place could I have gained in such a short time? But by appearances one can reason that it is not good. Upon inquiry, I learned that whatever tall buildings and fine stores I saw all belonged to Christians.

The ship reached Rhodes on May 18 and stayed for three or four hours. This is a very small island whose extent our classical historians have described as sixty miles, and in the geography translated by the Aligarh Society, the length is written as forty miles and the width fifteen miles.[33] This, too, is among the classical conquests. It was conquered in the time of Amīr Muʿāwiyah in 52 Hijrī [672], and at that time many Muslims went and settled there. I was eager to visit it on account of its antiquity, but unfortunately it was nighttime [19] and none of the people on the ship would go with me. An even greater misfortune was that, as it happened, the same reasons confronted me on the return trip, and I was left entirely deprived of a visit to it.

On the morning of May 20, we arrived at Izmir. Because this is a very large port, the ship remained here for two days. I disembarked with my Syrian friends. There was the same tażkirah inquiry on the shore, but

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thanks to my companions, I did not have much trouble. This city, which in English they call Smyrna, is the headquarters of Asia Minor, and no city in this district is more expansive and populous. It is also a monumental location with regard to antiquity and historical events. The grave of Homer, who was a famous poet of Greece and about whom the thought of Europe is that he was the greatest poet in the world, is right here. One of the seven churches that are mentioned in the Book of Revelation in the New Testament was in this city. The vicissitudes of time have destroyed it ten times. Still, its current population is greater than one lakh. The land in the area is extremely fertile, and the city itself is a major center of trade. Scores of steamships and sailboats are always present in the port. The rail, too, runs here, and the train departs from here twice a day.

Islamic monuments are in abundance. People have recounted to me that the number of masjids is no less than three hundred, among which some are of great glory and grandeur.

When we disembarked the ship, we saw a series of extremely tall and glorious [20] buildings that stretched far into the distance in a straight line along the sea. These buildings are hotels, coffeehouses, dance houses, and the shops of Christian traders, and are extremely beautiful, spacious, and full of atmosphere. At night, it always seems that there is some festival or a wedding party. In addition to the coffeehouses and the dance houses, there is always a large crowd on the street, and wherever you go, you hear the sound of singing and sarod. Behind this series of buildings is the neighborhood of the Christians, and there are such tall and glorious buildings as I had never seen before. All the lanes and alleys of this neighborhood are extremely clean and level.

Having finished my tour of this neighborhood, I turned toward the city. Although the city is extremely vibrant and seems like a festival because of the large number of people, all the streets are uneven and unclean, and it is difficult to walk down the street because of the filth and mud. The reality is that in all these regions, the administration of the municipality is extremely bad, and this matter is extremely worthy of the attention of the Turkish government. As we were walking, our Syrian friends became hungry, and we went and sat at the shop of a *nān-bā'ī* [baker]. I did not have an appetite, but I joined at their insistence. By the word *baker*, our

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readers will probably have thought of the bakers of India and their vile shops. But this supposition is not correct. The look of the appointments at the most ordinary of ordinary shops here is that numerous small tables, and chairs around them, are arranged. An extremely clean sheet is spread on the tables. A tap is set up in one corner of the wall, and beneath it a basin, and to the right side, soap and a towel are laid out. This is the condition of extremely ordinary shops, and the large shops, [21] which can be called hotels [restaurants], are extremely elaborate and magnificent. But all the hotels of this kind generally belong to Christians.

I tried to tour the madrasas, but because it was Friday, all the madrasas were closed. I performed namāz at the Hisar Congregational Mosque [Jāmiʿ Ḥiṣār].[34] This masjid is ceremonious and decorated. There is gilt ornamentation on the ceiling. The great virtue of this masjid is that bells are set on two large pillars on both sides of the courtyard because of which, in addition to knowing the timings of namāz, the masjid is also decorated. It would be good if this were imitated in our Hindustan. There are several innovations in the sermons and namāz here, but neither do they have any basis in the sharia, nor are they suitable in their own right. When the preacher reads the sermon, he regularly stops in the middle, and at that time several people recite something in unison. When they become silent, the preacher begins again, and this happens several times. They generally read short sūras in namāz, which are not more than three or four *āyats*, even though throughout the entire world it is customary to read long sūras in Friday namāz.

After finishing with namāz, I went into the library. This is not a large library. It is a very small room in the corner of the masjid, and there are three or four small cabinets of books. After namāz, most ʿulamā and authors come and sit here. When I arrived, the following people were present: Maulānā Muṣṭafā Āfāndī, imam of the Congregational Masjid and instructor at the madrasa; Ṣabrī Āfandī, teacher at the *iʿdādī* school;[35] Maulānā Saʿīd; Shukrī Bey; and Ḥusnī Afandī, former secretary of education.[36] [22] After salām and standard greetings, one ṣāḥib declared, "We were just talking about an issue. If you wish, let the issue be raised again." I gladly agreed. It was a debate about *mutʿah*,[37] and the same famous point of uncertainty was before us that it is proven by the word of Ḥazrat ʿUmar

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(ra) himself that the custom of temporary marriage was current in the lifetime of the Prophet (saas). I discussed it in some detail and everyone present agreed. These people did not understand Arabic, so I spoke in Persian. This custom of debate and discussion is commonly practiced in these regions and is an extremely polite and proper custom. A foreign person has no easier and more beneficial means of meeting a group of ʿulamā and producing a connection and intimacy with them. Its great virtue is that disputation does not take place by reason of egotism and arrogance; rather, if during the discussion they come to know, by means of the addressee's manner, that he cannot successfully discharge his duty in the debate, then they purposefully bring up another topic. Intellectual-scientific assemblies of this kind were a major means of my success on this journey, and, in some places, thanks to them alone I obtained deliverance from difficulties from which there was no other means of escape.

The ship raised anchor around evening on May 21. There is no large station from here to Constantinople. The ship stopped at a few places for a short time each, but we could not disembark. These places are mostly for the necessities of war, and at each place the instruments of war are assembled in abundance. Chanāq Qilʿah [Çanakkale] is one place where there is an extremely secure fort. People recounted to me that when Muḥammad Fātiḥ[38] decided to conquer Constantinople, [23] cannons and cannonballs were not generally in use, and Muḥammad cast cannons himself and had clay cannonballs made, some of which have survived as memorials. These cannonballs are well built and extremely strong, and it is recounted that they are no less than iron cannonballs. From Izmir to Constantinople, such secure fortresses and barrier walls have been set up on both sides of the sea, and the provisions of war are in such abundance, that even the most powerful of powerful sultanates cannot attempt to attack the capital by this route. All these fortresses and fortifications are from the age of Muḥammad Fātiḥ. When this renowned *emperor* went forth with the plan to capture Constantinople, he had military cantonments built all around and had fortresses and barrier walls prepared. (But all the details in this section are peoples' oral reports. I have not confirmed this in the history.)

Moving beyond Chanāq Qilʿah, we saw a strange spectacle. The ship was moving quickly when from afar something appeared to be erupting

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like a fountain in the water. After a little while, I learned that four or five fish were racing toward the ship. When they came near, they joined the ship. One could clearly see their body through the surface of the water. Although the ship was going extremely fast, they kept right along with it. Sometimes, when they would gasp, they would hiss loudly, and at that time one could see something like a fountain erupting in the water. They raced alongside the ship for nearly two miles. All the people watched the spectacle in wonder. Several had the idea, "These fish have never seen the form of a ship. Thus, they thought it was some animal, and, in the passion of competition, [24] did not want the ship to be able to outrun them." During my return trip, too, just such an incident occurred, and at that time I discovered that the fish had happened to come to this place one time, and the ship's employees tossed something into the sea for them to eat. Greedy for this, whenever a ship passes through here, these fish often appear and race alongside the ship for a distance.

We arrived at Constantinople in the morning on May 23. The ship anchored. This was a time at which I should have been extremely happy to arrive at my destination, but in the commotion and shouting of the coolies and boatmen, I lost my senses; and the boatmen surrounded the entire ship. With their shouting, pushing, and shoving, a strange commotion had arisen. I had not determined beforehand, nor could I, where to go after disembarking the ship. A hotel was not appropriate to my situation (the reason for this will be made known later), and because of my foreignness and unfamiliarity, I could not be assured of or rely upon serais. The serious difficulty was that my Syrian friends, from whom assistance of every kind could have been expected, were in a hurry to reach the college. Thus, they could not wait for me. Finding me alone, the boatmen and coolies began to harass me even more. My distress continued to grow from the thought that if I had this much trouble on the ship on account of the foreignness of the language, how would things be in the city? It became later and later in this dawdle and delay. Most of the travelers had disembarked the ship and continued to disembark. Finally, I turned my luggage over to the steward and told him, "I shall return having toured the city." My intention was first to go into the city to make some arrangement for my stay, [25] then to remove my things from the ship. Some Arabs from

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Syria had rented a boat. I, too, went along with them. There was passport inquiry and inspection on the shore. I showed my English papers, but they asked for a passport. In short, with a thousand difficulties, I was released. Now I was confused as to where I should go. On the boat, I was introduced to a Syrian Arab whose name was ʿAbd al-Fattāḥ.[39] I described my distress to him and said, "Please, tell me some reasonable way to proceed." He said, "My situation is nearly the same as yours. Thus, it is best that we stay together." Although this course of action was opposed to caution, I had to adopt it because of my unfamiliarity and the foreignness of the language. And if you ask the truth, this chance company was the preface of all my future success.

Hotels, Serais, and Places for Rent. There are several manners of lodging for travelers here. The greatest surety and ease is in hotels. However, firstly, their rate is no less than one pound, that is, fifteen rupees, per day. And second, most—rather, nearly all—the excellent hotels are in the European area, which is far from Istanbul, and all the congregational masjids, libraries, madrasas, and schools are in Istanbul.

After hotels there are *khānāt*, that is, serai, but these serais have no relation to Hindustan. Here, all the rooms in large serais are generally large, spacious, and attractive, and a bed made of woven strips, *toshak* mattress, sheets, blanket, and necessary things are always furnished in them. [26] There are several beds in each room, and the rate is eight or ten annas per bed.

The third method is rental houses. These houses are typically two or three stories. On each level are numerous rooms, and in each room, a table, chair, couch, lamp, carpet, bed, mattress, pillow, and blanket are provided. The rent per room is typically from ten rupees per month to twenty or thirty. The owners or leaseholders of these houses are generally Christian. They themselves also live in these houses, and because of them, travelers experience a great deal of ease.

Although, as I have just described, taking a house on rent would have been the easier option, my Syrian friend and I were both unaware of it. Thus, we went and stayed in a khān, meaning a serai. When I was satisfied with this arrangement, I went back onto the ship and had my luggage

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removed and brought. We lived in that khān for six or seven days. Then we took an excellent house near the *Bāb-i ʿālī* on rent.

The Circumstances of Shaikh ʿAbd al-Fattāḥ. Fortunately, Shaikh ʿAbd al-Fattāḥ, with whom I made friends by compulsion, turned out to be a person from a very esteemed family. Ḥažrat Shaikh Khālid Naqshbandī was a revered elder in Damascus to whom the people here are so devoted that they do not utter his name, rather, they refer to him with the word *ḥažrat* [his majesty].[40] This elder was nurtured in the pure soil of our Hindustan. That is, he was a disciple of Mirzā Jān-i Jānān Dihlawī.[41] Shaikh ʿAbd al-Fattāḥ is his fraternal nephew, and [27] because of this relationship, people hold him in high esteem. Because there is a large group of Syrians in Constantinople, ʿAbd al-Fattāḥ became acquainted with most people within just a few days, and, by means of him, I, too, was introduced to them in turn.

Meeting Shaikh ʿAlī Ẓabyān. One day, Shaikh ʿAlī Ẓabyān, whose father is a famous Ṣūfī, came to meet Shaikh ʿAbd al-Fattāḥ. I, too, was present at the time, and it just so happened that the tract *Iskāt al-Muʿtadī*, which is an old work of mine and is in Arabic, was lying in front of us.[42] Picking it up, he looked at it and said, "Aha! I saw this tract some time ago at my shaikh's place in Damascus, and he said of its author, "*Shakkar Allāh masaʾʿiyah*."[43] When Shaikh ʿAlī Ẓabyān learned that the tract was written by none other than me, he stood up and embraced me with passionate warmth and treated me with extreme grace and kindness. I was extremely delighted by the fact that my insignificant writing had come all the way here and people looked upon it with eyes of acceptance, and in the loneliness of the journey, such a means of introduction felt like a great blessing. Shaikh ʿAlī Ẓabyān is a young man. He was educated in fiqh by Shaikh ʿAbd al-Raḥmān, who was the maternal grandson and student of the author of *Radd al-muḥtār* (known as Shāmī [the Syrian]).[44] Although he has aptitude in most of the current sciences, he has the greatest mastery in literature. He presented an undotted *qaṣīdah* in praise of the sulṭān, upon which he received reward and recompense. He has been a guest of Darwesh Pāshā for some time and the aforementioned pāshā treats him as a

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dear friend.[45] His relationship with me grew stronger by the day. So much so that despite the great distance, he would come to my place nearly every day and sometimes would stay with me for the entire day. [28] Shaikh ʻAbd al-Fattāḥ returned to Damascus after a few days. Alone, I might perhaps have run into hardship at that time, but Shaikh ʻAlī Ẓabyān's sympathies removed all anxiety from my heart.

Although the house that we had taken on rent was extremely spacious, attractive, and elegant, because the landlord (temporary) was extremely dishonest in business and vagrant in temperament, after a few days, I took another house on rent and stayed there until the end. Here, not only was the place very nice, but it was also a great comfort that the landlord was a kind-natured woman. Although she was Christian and was of the Italian nation, she could speak Arabic as needed and had special closeness with Muslims.

We had no need for arrangements for food and drink. Hotels and shops are in abundance, and they are extremely neat and elaborate. To eat in the marketplace is absolutely not a matter of disgrace here. I often saw esteemed officials eating in hotels. These hotels generally belong to Christians. The shops of Muslims, except that there are also chairs and tables there, in all other respects resemble the shops of Hindustan.

The qaṣīdah that I began to write on the ship came to completion upon arrival at Constantinople. Included in it is a summary sketch of the circumstances of the journey, and because readers, having become familiar with the details of all the circumstances, will be able to understand well the allusions in the qaṣīdah that require a backstory and will take more enjoyment and pleasure in it, I copy the qaṣīdah in its entirety here. [29]

Ode[46]

For both the completion of my subject and in search of edification,[47]
For ages it has been my intention to travel.
Having fulfilled the duty of ḥajj and pilgrimage by God's decree,
I desired to journey to Turkey.
Although I burned with desire and was eager to make haste,
By the dictates of fate, postponement continued.
There was such a delay that the spiteful said,

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"So-and-so has nothing in his head but half-baked desire.
As if Turkey were just two or three steps away, this dreamer of half-baked dreams
Has, without a care, tightly girded his loins for the journey.
The path is so long and the journey so perilous;
How is it achievable by one who has neither power nor gold?"
I worried and suffered greatly in this frustration and grief.
Suddenly, the manifestation of my desire walked through the door.
There took place a wondrous coincidence which unraveled this knot,
Of which even imagination and thought were unaware.
A couple of months before I beat the drum of departure,
My heart was frail and burnt from the strife of fever.
When I became weak with fever, it occurred to my heart,
"There is no remedy but a change of place, here and now."
I remembered my longstanding intent and thought it would be nice
If the Lord accomplished two tasks in a single act.
Arnold, who is both my colleague and my teacher,
Also planned to travel to England at the time.
I thought to myself, "Such company and such an occasion rarely occur."
Thus, I leapt eagerly from my place, intent on this journey.
When all became aware of my intention,
News also spread to friends and dear ones at home.
The kindness of all was stirred, and hearts ached.
All said, "Do not go to this useless trouble. [30]
Do not set hearts in separation; and do not forsake the way of fidelity.
And if you will not retreat from this path,
Rest a few days, then arrange
The provisions of the journey in a way that is suitable.
Take enough cash and goods with you that
There will be no danger or worry if you stay long.
It is best not to make this journey alone;
You must also bring along a servant."
I said, "All that you have said is a wise counsel,
But the seeker-student is not in the game of profit and loss.
When a man takes a step forth at this stage,

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He does not withdraw it, even if it brings death."
In short, it was from the twenty-sixth of Ramžān that I
Rose fervently from my place and set out upon my journey.
For a time I traveled through mountains and deserts,
Then I and other friends boarded a ship.
I endured trouble and hardship for two or three days on the ship,
It so rose and fell at every moment because of the waves.
No one had the power to lift his head from his pillow.
No one had the power to separate his body from his bed.
Nothing on the ship causes torment
Except for this three-day trial, from which there is no escape.
Bread and foods of every kind were available to us,
Lamb kabob and chicken and wine and fruits and sweets.
Although I did not pollute my lip with that pure wine,
Others, by contrast, quaffed from the goblet.
On the seventh of May, when we reached Aden,
The ship came to rest and dropped anchor for a while.
I disembarked and turned toward the city
In order to find information about the desert and towns of this region.
It is a mountainous area, in which, although it is high and vast,
There is no trace of greenery or flowers.
Every place you pass by, there is flowing sand and clay.
Every place you go, there is black dust and stone. [31]
The Guebres and Christians[48] who have settled in this place
Spoke entirely in the Arabic language.
The people of the city, who call themselves Somali,
Are animals. No. In fact, they are even worse than animals.
Wretched, ill-fated, ruinous, black-skinned, and disgusting.
Vile, contemptible, perverse, and bad both by substance and by birth.
They have attached themselves to Arabia, but heaven forbid that
The Lord approve of such base and vile ones!
Because the language of all is Tāzī [Arabic] and, just like the Arabs,
Their name is tied to the title of their ancestors and fathers,
Common people fall into error and incorrectly believe
That they are from the lineage and descent of Maʿd and Mužar.[49]

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The seed, and the roots, too, of this tree are from the soil of Ḥabash;[50]
It has bloomed and scattered fruit in this place.
In the evening, our ship set out again
And passed through the Red Sea for a week.
It came to Suez and came to a stop and it happened so quickly
That I was not aware of its condition or state.
This is that wondrous channel, of such a feat
I had never heard except in ancient tales;
It is twenty leagues long and so wide
That two steamships can pass through it.
A Frenchman named Lesseps[51]
Designed it and became famous throughout the world.
When in the beginning that wise man made the claim
That one could bring the task to completion,
The people mocked him and said that this
Was foolishness which no wise person would believe.
It was from the fourteenth of May that we arrived
At Port Said and boarded another ship.
Separation befell Arnold and me,
For my path and his parted at this crossing.
The port is a place filled with skiffs, boats, and steamships
As far as the eye can see. [32]
See a hundred that have raised flag here;
See a hundred that have dropped anchor there.
In the evening, our ship set sail again and passed
By way of Jaffa and then stopped at Beirut.
I went ashore and a man of the sons of Aleppo
Accompanied me and became my guide in every quarter.
It is a nice place where he cannot help but give away his heart
Who has fervor and passion in it.
It is a pleasant place, a fine spot to visit, and an attractive location:
Roads, even; land, clean; buildings, spectacular.
Giaours and Muslims alike, all well dressed and fine in form.
Elite and common, all rose-hued bodies and beautiful faces.
Their clothes resemble Arabia, as do their uniform and dress.

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There is no difference between Muslim and nonbeliever.
When I left this place, it was because I had no choice.
I went ahead and my eye turned back once more.
It was the sixteenth of May when we departed.
Then at dawn we reached Cyprus.
This is the ancient place which, in the age of Amīr (meaning Amīr Muʿāwiyah),[52]
An army went to seize, and victory was augured.
At present, the government of England has taken it from the Turks,
But in peaceful treaty, not by aid of sword and hatchet.
I saw the congregational masjid and palace of Cyprus.
My visit to this place gave rise to more wondrous signs.
Rhodes and Chios[53] appeared along the way, and, after that, Izmir.
The ship stopped at Izmir and spent one night there.
I went to the city and saw, one by one,
Masjid, school, market, street, alley, and door.
I performed my Friday duty and, after prayers,
I happened to pass by the *sulṭānī* library.
An assembly of jurisprudents was gathered there.
A discussion of mutʿah and the words of ʿUmar was underway.[54]
One of them turned toward me, "How are you? What are you?
Why have you tied the garment of toil at your waist?" [33]
I said, "I am from Hind, a beggar for crumbs from the table of culture;[55]
I carry away something from every place and country."
He said, "Just now discussion of mutʿah was underway, and you, too,
If you can, should speak a few words and give example."
In response, I knocked on the door of meaning and the audience
Opened lips of praise after debate and deliberation.
Then I departed from Izmir and in the span of two days
This route was traversed, and this volume reached its end.
I have written these letters briefly, and you, too, know
That in this lonely wilderness, the traveler is in straits.
Anyone who seeks the circumstances and details of me and my journey
Should be told to read this poem from end to end.

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